The Product Organisation Health Check

Thirty statements about how your product organisation actually runs, as opposed to how the operating model slides say it runs. Score what happened in the last quarter. Best run with your leadership team scoring independently, then comparing: the disagreements are the findings. Nothing you enter leaves this page.

0 / 60 · 0 of 30 answered

Tick as you go; the verdict appears here.

Strategy and Bets

1. We can state our product strategy in three sentences, and the last three roadmap decisions visibly followed from it.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

2. Every major initiative is framed as a hypothesis with a falsifiable success measure and a date.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

3. We have killed or descoped something meaningful in the last two quarters because the evidence said so.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

4. We say no in public: stakeholders can see what was deprioritised and why.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

5. The strategy names the customer problems we are betting on, not just the technologies we are adopting.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

Customer and Discovery

6. Someone on each product team spoke to a real customer in the last two weeks.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

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7. Discovery findings change decisions: we can point to a recent build reshaped or stopped by research.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

8. We watch behaviour, not just listen to opinions: analytics and research are used together.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

9. Frontline colleagues have a working route to feed what they hear into product decisions.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

10. We know which segment each product primarily serves, and our metrics are cut by it.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

Delivery and Flow

11. Work flows in small batches: the typical item reaches customers in weeks, not quarters.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

12. We measure flow (cycle time, waiting, throughput), not just velocity and utilisation.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

13. All work is visible, including support, favours and incidents; the board reflects true capacity.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

14. Dependencies between teams are visible and actively managed, not discovered at integration.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

15. Done means in customers' hands, and everyone uses the word that way.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

People and Capability

16. Product people have a published career path, and someone moved along it in the last year.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

17. Managers coach: 1:1s are about problems and growth, not status reporting.

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◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

18. We can name each product person's current stretch, the thing they are learning by doing.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

19. Communities of practice exist, meet and change how work is done.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

20. Capability is assessed against a shared framework, so development plans are specific.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

AI and Data Readiness

21. Our AI initiatives are framed by customer outcome; each could be described without naming the technology.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

22. For every AI feature, someone owns what happens when it is wrong and what that costs.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

23. Evals, thresholds and kill criteria exist as product artefacts, reviewed by product.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

24. We know the unit economics: cost per interaction today and the curve at ten times the volume.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

25. Product managers use AI in their own daily work; the capability is practised, not sponsored.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

Leadership and Operating Model

26. Decisions have named owners; teams know which are theirs and which need escalation.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

27. Leadership reviews outcomes and bets, not activity and utilisation.

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◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

28. Funding follows products and outcomes, not annual project business cases.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

29. When something fails, we run a blameless review and can name what changed after the last one.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

30. The operating model has been deliberately revisited in the last year, not inherited by habit.

◯ True, evidence exists ◯ Partly ◯ Not true

The variance reading: wherever two leaders score the same statement 2 points apart, you have found an information gap or a courage gap. Both are leadership work, and both are worth more than the total.

How I use this: re-run quarterly, chase the trend, not the number, and change at most two dimensions' worth of practice per quarter. If you want it run properly with your leadership team in the room, that is a thing I do.

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